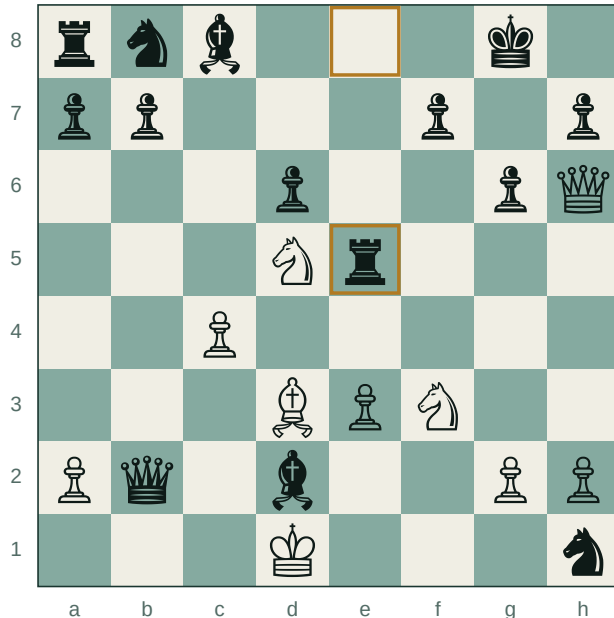


Kingside attacks: White, move 17

Kingside attacks

White to move



Previous move: 16...Rxe5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

17. Nf6+ Kh8 18. Qxh7#

17.Nf6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **17...Kh8**.

18.Qxh7# Mate: queen on h7 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on h7. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not count distant pieces as attackers unless they can reach useful squares in time. Every preparatory move gives the defender a turn.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A kingside attack succeeds when pieces and pawn breaks create concrete threats near the king. The attack must arrive before the defender can exchange attackers or counter in the center.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the pieces that can join immediately, identify an entry square, and calculate the defender's checks and exchanges.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on c8 and rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.